

BFS218

Racism and the Digital Age

Understanding Techno-Racism

A short, friendly map to your course companion site, what it is, where everything lives, and how to make it work for you.

BFS218

The course reading room

There is one BFS218 site for the course. Open it from Blackboard or use the public address in this guide.

START HERE

Your reading room, not another inbox

The companion site gathers every assigned reading, key concept, walkthrough, and self-check for BFS218 into one calm place, organized the way the course actually runs. No account, no login, nothing you do here is graded or tracked. Read, practise, and explore freely.



What it is

- Your course reading room, in working order
- Every reading, concept, and self-check in one spot
- A companion that sits beside Blackboard



What it is not

- Not a replacement for Blackboard
- Not where announcements or submissions live
- Not graded, tracked, or reported, ever

The menu is the map

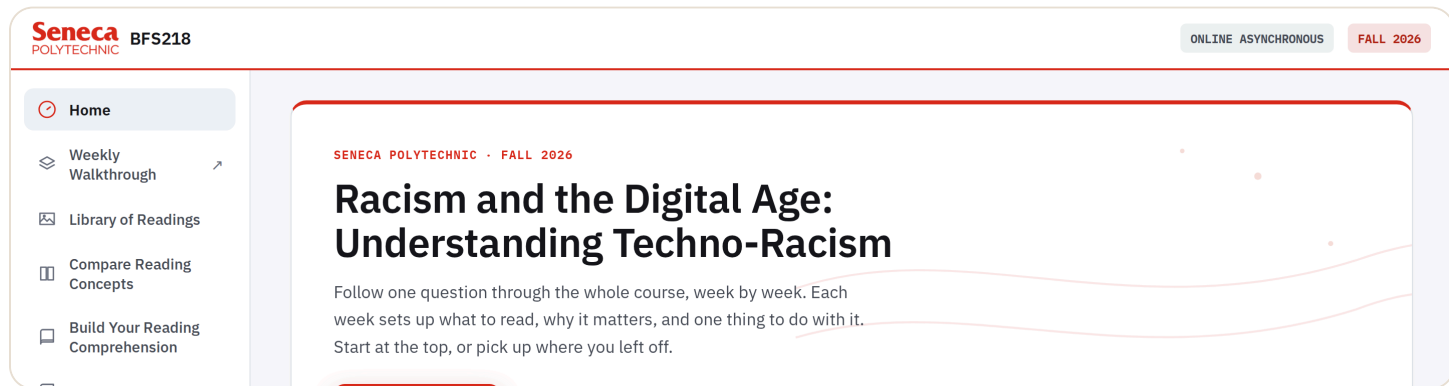
The left-hand menu is the entire site. Here is every door and where it leads.

● ● ● BFS218, navigation	
 Home The course journey, week by week	 Understanding the Assignments Plain-language assignment guide, grading criteria, and FAQ
 Scholar Video Gallery Official embeds, organized by week, with reading prompts	 Library of Readings Every assigned source, as a card
 Compare Reading Concepts Hold up to three readings side by side	 Build Your Reading Comprehension Turn any reading into practice questions
 Glossary & Thinkers Every key term, and the scholars behind it	 Self-check Flip cards & short quizzes, never scored
 Weekly Walkthrough Every week's narrated deck, in one hub	 By week · Tiles · Index Three more ways into the same library

The course as a journey

Home lays the course out week by week. Each station shows the week's title and its **guiding question**, the one question worth carrying through everything you read that week.

- 1 Click any week station to open that week's page.
- 2 Coming back later? The site remembers where you were on this device and offers to pick up where you left off.



HOME · THE COURSE JOURNEY, EACH WEEK WITH ITS GUIDING QUESTION

TWO SUPPORT ROOMS

Assignments and scholar videos

These two menu items help you understand the course before you start writing. They do not replace Blackboard, the course outline, or the assignment instructions posted there.

UNDERSTANDING THE ASSIGNMENTS

What am I being asked to do?

Pick an assignment to see its purpose, what you submit, what strong work usually does, common misses, grading criteria, and a short FAQ. Use it to plan; submit only through Blackboard.

SCHOLAR VIDEO GALLERY

A careful on-ramp, not a shortcut

The gallery organizes official scholar videos by week. Each card tells you what the video explains, what to watch for, and which reading to return to next. The videos support the readings; they do not replace them.

See the course through your program

BFS218 asks how racism travels through technology, and that question lands differently depending on where you are headed. Right on Home you can reframe the whole course around your own program of study, so techno-racism shows up in the tools and systems your field builds and uses every day.

- 1 On Home, find the control that says **See this course through your program**. Pick your program from the dropdown of Seneca programs, grouped by area of study. You can also pick a whole area, or choose **Still exploring**.
- 2 You stay on Home. Nothing navigates away. A short **For your field** panel appears at the top, tying the whole course to your program.
- 3 Each week on the journey gains its own short **For your field** line, and the weeks that matter most to your field are marked **Key for your field**.
- 4 For the deeper write-up, open **Career Choices** from the menu: several paragraphs on how the course connects to your field, plus a scenario, the skills you will build, and the roles it points to.
- 5 A small chip at the top shows **Viewing as your program**, with a way to change it or turn it off. Your choice follows you across the site until you do.

A lens, not a different course

Every student reads the same readings and does the same assessments. The lens only changes how the course is framed for you, it never changes what is required. You can turn it off any time, and the chip at the top of the page is how you do it.

Anatomy of a week

Every week page runs in the order the week is meant to run. Work it top to bottom.

This week in 80 seconds. Content weeks open with a short animated overview under the week title, made with NotebookLM from that week's readings and reviewed by your instructor. Captions available on the player. It is a fast on-ramp into the week, not a substitute for the readings.

Study Guide. Before the Knowledge Check, each teaching week carries a rehearsal space: a quick warm-up from earlier weeks, explain-it-back cards where you put each key concept in your own words and compare with the reading, and a question ladder that works the week's guiding questions from recall to application. Nothing is recorded or graded; your notes stay in your own browser.

Knowledge Check. Every week closes with an optional, never scored self-check. Set A and Set B are multiple choice, this week's ideas plus a short review from earlier weeks; Set C is different, with short scenarios, matching, and a written reflection you compare against a model. After you answer, you can say how sure you were, and the summary shows not just what you got right but where a confident answer was actually wrong, the thing most worth fixing. Nothing is recorded; clear or change any answer and take another set fresh.

- 1 **Time budget**, under the title, roughly how the week's work divides up.
- 2 **Your learning path**, the short checklist that tells you what to do first, next, and last.
- 3 **Overview & purpose**, read this first; it tells you what the week is about and why it matters.
- 4 **Guiding questions**, carry one question with you into the readings.
- 5 **Key concepts & terms**, cited to the readings so you always know where an idea comes from.
- 6 **Readings**, full citations and buttons for open access, Seneca Library, Blackboard, or earlier course sources.
- 7 **Reading Rescue**, the shortest honest path back into the reading if you are behind. Use it, then return to the source.
- 8 **A Visual Overview**, a labelled 3D-style map of the week. Read the labels and explanation before treating it as evidence.
- 9 **Walkthrough & case study**, the slide deck and the applied example that show how the week works in practice.
- 10 **The activity**, a guided 3D practice space. Use the controls, read the prompts, and connect the model back to the reading.
- 11 **Reflect & save**, a short prompt you can export as a Word document to keep your work.
- 12 **You can now**, the week's closing checklist. Anything left unticked shows what to revisit.

Seneca POLYTECHNIC BFS218 ONLINE ASYNCHRONOUS FALL 2026

[Home](#)
[Weekly Walkthrough](#)
[Library of Readings](#)
[Compare Reading Concepts](#)
[Build Your Reading Comprehension](#)
[Glossary & Thinkers](#)

[Back to your journey](#)

WEEK 3

Engineered Inequity

This week opens Part II of the course, where we take the New Jim Code apart one dimension at a time. We begin with the first dimension, engineered inequity: technology that, by its design, amplifies social hierarchies of race, class, and gender while presenting itself as neutral or efficient. The key idea is amplify, not create: the inequality is already in society, and the design widens it, speeds it up, and makes it harder to escape. By the end of the week you should be able to define engineered inequity, answer Benjamin's question are robots racist, and name a real example.

IN THIS WEEK

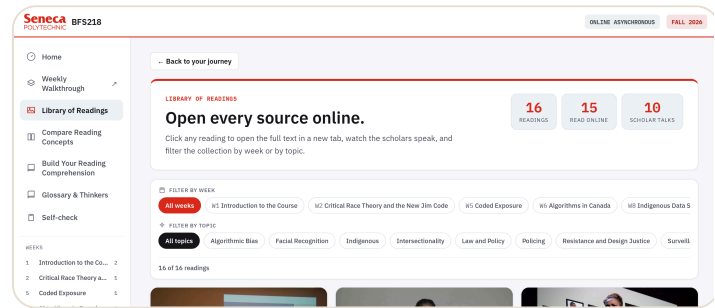
- ☐ Overview
- ☐ This week in 80 seconds
- ☐ Before you begin
- ☐ Purpose
- ☐ Learning outcomes
- ☐ Guiding questions
- ☐ Key concepts
- ☐ Key terms

A WEEK PAGE · EVERYTHING IN WORKING ORDER, TOP TO BOTTOM

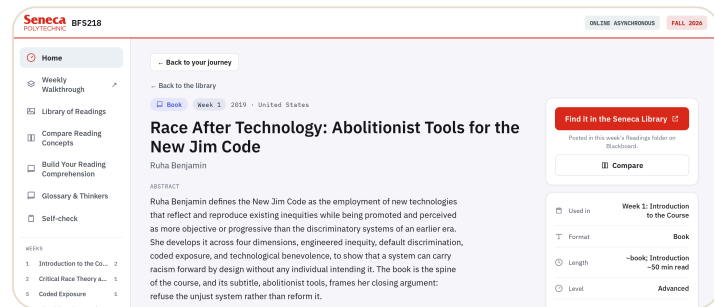
Every reading, as a card

The library holds every course reading: what it is, what it argues, how long it takes, and how to reach it.

- 1 Search any author, title, or idea.
- 2 Filter to one week with the week strip, or browse by format.
- 3 Click a card for the reading's page: core idea, plain-language abstract, level and length, and where the text lives.
- 4 Press the red button to open the reading. A Source page button appears where a separate source or DOI exists.
- 5 Bookmark a reading to your Saved shelf. It stays on this device so you can return before an assessment.



EVERY SOURCE AS A CARD, SEARCHABLE BY WEEK

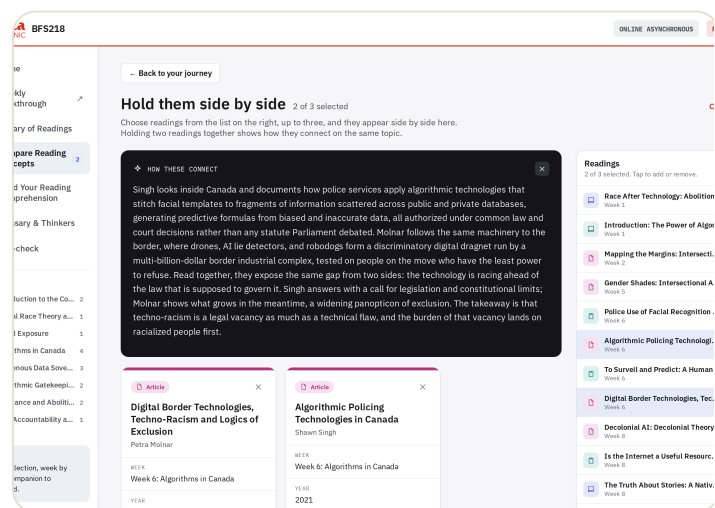


A READING PAGE · CORE IDEA, ABSTRACT, AND THE OPEN BUTTON

COMPARE READING CONCEPTS

Hold up to three readings side by side

- 1 Open Compare from the menu, or press Compare on any reading page.
- 2 Pick up to three readings. Each becomes a column: week, year, origin, length, level, and core idea.
- 3 With two or more selected, press **Synthesize their relationship**. The site explains how they speak to each other, every idea attributed.
- 4 With three, it takes the pairings one at a time, then asks what only appears when all three are on the table.
- 5 Remove a reading with the × on its column, or Clear all to start over.



EACH PAIRING EXPLAINED, EVERY IDEA ATTRIBUTED

Turn any reading into practice

Choose a reading, choose a lens, and answer. Every answer comes back with a short explanation grounded in the reading itself, so a wrong answer still teaches you something specific.

LENS 01

Thematic

What it is about.

LENS 02

Argument

What it claims, and why.

LENS 03

Context

Where it sits in the field and the course.

GLOSSARY & THINKERS

Never defined out of thin air

- Browse by week (including the closing weeks) or search any term.
- Every definition carries a citation to that week's assigned reading.
- The *Scholars this week* strip introduces the people behind the readings. Click a name to jump to their reading.

SELF-CHECK

Practice, never scored

- Pick a week, or take all weeks together.
- Flip the cards: term on the front, definition and citation on the back.
- Run the short quizzes; each question explains its answer. Nothing is recorded, it exists so you know what to reread before it matters.



Weekly Walkthrough hub. Every week's deck also lives in one place. Open it from the menu and pick the week to rewatch without hunting.

HANDS-ON

The studios & labs

Alongside the weekly activities, the site carries hands-on labs. Each one tells you what you are doing and why before you start. Nothing in them is graded.

Evidence Transfer Lab

Move a claim from source to argument, deliberately.

Accountability Chain Lab

Trace who answers for a harm, link by link.

Self-Check Studio

Package your studio work as a Word document to keep.

THREE MORE WAYS INTO THE LIBRARY

Browse it however you think

By week

Everything, week by week.

Tiles

The whole library as a wall you can scan.

Index

The alphabetical list.

GOOD HABITS FOR THE TERM

A rhythm that works

STEP 1

Open the week page early and read the overview.

STEP 2

Do the readings with one guiding question in hand.

STEP 3

Step through the walkthrough.

STEP 4

Do the activity.

STEP 5

Tick the You can now checklist honestly.

Before each assessment, use **Compare** on the readings you plan to write about, and run **Self-check** for those weeks.

PRACTICAL NOTES

Good to know

- Works on phones, tablets, and laptops, and is fully keyboard-navigable.
- Your saved shelf, checklists, and progress live only in your own browser, on your own device.
- Clearing browser data clears them, and they do not follow you between devices.
- If the site looks stale after an announced update, refresh the page once.

THE ONE RULE THAT MATTERS

When in doubt, Blackboard wins.

The companion site is your reading room. Blackboard is the course of record: announcements, discussions, every submission, and every grade live there, and the course outline is the authoritative schedule.

Where to go for what

Understand an assignment	Understanding the Assignments ► pick the assignment
Watch a scholar explain the topic	Scholar Video Gallery ► choose the week ► return to the reading
Get unstuck on readings	Week page ► Readings ► Reading Rescue
Start this week's work	Home ► click the week ► work top to bottom
Find a reading fast	Library of Readings ► search or week strip
See how readings connect	Compare Reading Concepts ► pick up to three
Test yourself on a reading	Build Your Reading Comprehension ► pick a lens
Look up a term	Glossary & Thinkers ► search
Drill before an assessment	Self-check ► pick the weeks
Rewatch the week's deck	Weekly Walkthrough ► pick the week
Submit anything / check grades	Blackboard, always